



THE COUNT'S RING

A Dungeons & Dragons 5e adventure

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The Count's Ring

humorous

D&D 5e (2014)

Level 1

Duration: campaign (5+ episodes)

Structure: linear

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△ Auto-translated from Italian. The Italian version is the source of truth.

The Count's Ring

Introduction

The realm of Drakenhold is enjoying its most radiant season. In the south of the realm, the village of **Fianus Romanus** - a sun-kissed hamlet surrounded by fertile lands - is the kind of place where nothing important ever happens. At least until **Sir Gorim Vel**, the Count's official, decides it's time to recruit a group of adventurers for a mission "of capital importance": finding **l'Anello del Conte** (the Count's Ring).

Nobody knows what the Ring is. Nobody knows what it does. Nobody knows where it is. And nobody knows the Count's name.

Welcome to Fianus Romanus.

General Plot

The PCs are hired by Sir Gorim Vel to recover the Count's Ring, which fell into the sewers of Fianus Romanus. They descend into the sewers and find only a mocking letter: someone - signed "S" - took the Ring before them and promises to show up at the Festa del Grazie. Gorim pays half the fee and binds them to him for the follow-up.

Concept

A D&D 5e (2014) episodic adventure, inspired by the Italian comedy series **Boris**. Humorous tone without going overboard: absurd situations treated seriously by the characters. Bureaucracy, incompetence, oversized egos. Structured as "episodes" like a TV season.

The adventure is the **prologue** to the serious campaign **Il Re Spezzato** (The Broken King). The Count is a local noble, not King Dorian Valemarch. In the final episode, just as the PCs are about to meet him and earn honor and glory, the Count dies in an explosion. No answers, no reward, no name. The Count's death and the ensuing chaos are the hook that drags the PCs into the larger story of Drakenhold and Il Re Spezzato.

PC Level: 1 (with progression during episodes)

Lore

Drakenhold - The name refers to both the **realm** and its **capital**, at the center of the continent. Ruled by **King Dorian Valemarch**.

Fianus Romanus - A village in southern Drakenhold, connected to the capital. Surrounded by fertile lands, it faces the sea to the south (like Ostia to Rome). Governed by the Count - a vassal of Dorian whose name nobody knows. Rural life, trade, traditions. Everyone knows everyone, everyone gossips, nobody works as much as they should. It has surprisingly elaborate sewers for a village of this size (nobody knows why). The population is almost entirely human - other races are rare and attract curiosity.

Available maps: `maps/RealmOfAmrog` (region), `maps/FianusRomanus` (village), `01_LeFogneDiFianus/maps/LeFogneDiFianus` (dungeon quest 1).

The PCs

The PCs are broke adventurers living in Fianus Romanus. Poverty is the narrative engine: they take on adventures to scrape together lunch and dinner.

Rule: each PC starts with **5 silver pieces**. Nothing else.

Main NPCs

Full sheets are in `characters/`.

Sir Gorim Vel

Fighter 3 (Defence) - The René Ferretti of Fianus Romanus

The Count's official, sent to manage the village. Stocky, exasperated, gesticulates with a scroll in hand. Tries to complete the mission with the resources he has - namely the PCs. He's not happy about it. He's the only NPC with direct (though vague) contact with the Count.

Recurring phrases: "Come on come on come on, we can do this", "Splendid. Wonderful." (sarcastic), "What are you doing?!", "I can't take it anymore with you lot".

→ Full sheet: `characters/NPC_SirGorimVel.md`

The Count

Noble - The living MacGuffin

Nobody knows his name. Nobody has seen his face. The only known fact is that he's a vassal of King Dorian Valemarch. He governs Fianus Romanus through letters, decrees, and messengers. His orders are often contradictory. In the final episode, just as the PCs are about to meet him, he dies in an explosion. No name, no face, no answers. His death and the power vacuum that follows are the hook toward Il Re Spezzato.

→ Full sheet: `characters/NPC_IlConte.md`

Running Gag

The Count's Name

Every time an NPC is about to say the Count's name, they get interrupted:

- A deafening noise that covers the word
- A sneeze
- Something collapsing
- "The Count... what's his name... wait, it's on the tip of my tongue..."
- Official letters have the seal but the signature is illegible
- An NPC swears they know it but wants to be paid first - then doesn't know it either

The Ring

Everyone talks about it, nobody knows what it does, nobody knows where it is:

- Every NPC has a different and incompatible theory
- Someone swears they've seen it (it was an onion ring)
- Gorim is convinced the PCs already know everything
- It's only found in the final episode, where "everything will be clear to everyone"

Boris Parallels

Boris	L'Anello del Conte
"The show" (Gli Occhi del Cuore) nobody understands	"The mission" (finding the Ring) nobody understands
René Ferretti	Sir Gorim Vel
Stanis La Rochelle	Pipinius Chennedius (PC)
Duccio	Gin Tonica (PC)
Corinna	Maria Biscanna (PC)
"Daje!"	Recurring village exclamation (TBD)
"Smarmella tutto"	Fantasy equivalent (TBD)

Future Hooks

Elements to seed during the comedic episodes:

- Gorim sometimes stops mid-sentence, worried about things that go beyond local incompetence
- The Count receives orders from someone higher up (the King?) - vague hints
- Nearby there's an abandoned mine (Nerrok) that "nobody wants to visit"
- The Count's death in the final episode isn't comedic - it's the moment the comedy ends
- Gorim receives an urgent message from the capital after the explosion: the King wants to see him
- The power vacuum left by the Count drags the PCs into the larger story of Drakenhold

Gorim's Arc (SPOILER - DM only)

After the explosion that kills the Count, Gorim changes. He's no longer the exasperated official - he's a man who lost his lord and couldn't do anything about it. Between L'Anello del Conte and Il Re Spezzato, **one year** passes. In that year Gorim is summoned to court and becomes King Dorian Valemarch's confidant and servant. When the PCs find him again in Il Re Spezzato, he's a different man: serious, weary, loyal to the bone. The contrast with the comedic Gorim from L'Anello del Conte is the strongest signal that the tone has changed.

During the comedic episodes, seed small moments where Gorim shows a loyalty and sense of duty that go beyond the gag - these are the traits that Dorian will notice and that will lead him to choose Gorim as his confidant.

Adventure Structure

Episode 1 - “Le Fogne di Fianus” (The Sewers of Fianus)

The PCs arrive in Fianus Romanus, get recruited by Gorim, and the first lead takes them into the village sewers. → [01_LeFogneDiFianus/](#)

Episode 2 - “La Festa del Grazie” (The Village Festival)

Fianus Romanus celebrates the Festa del Grazie. Sergius, disguised as an official, gives a public speech with veiled accusations against the Count, then launches a treasure hunt through the village. The PCs discover the vigor potion trade and the existence of a compromising portrait of the Count.

Episode 3 - “Il Rivale” (The Rival) (to be developed)

Another group of adventurers arrives, sent by the Count for the same mission. Comedic competition.

Episode 4 - “La Pista Vera (forse)” (The Real Lead (maybe)) (to be developed)

A lead takes them outside the village. A merchant of counterfeit rings. A real clue the PCs don't recognize.

Episode 5 - “Il Finale di Stagione” (The Season Finale) (to be developed)

The PCs are finally about to meet the Count. Explosion. The Count dies. No name, no face, no Ring, no answers. The chaos that follows drags them toward Il Re Spezzato.

Appendix — Stat Blocks

BABOON - BABOON

Small beast, unaligned

exotic animal escaped from crates

Armor Class 12

Hit Points 3 (1d6)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses passive Perception 11

Languages -

Challenge 0

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)	4 (-3)	12 (+1)	6 (-2)

Pack Tactics. The baboon has advantage on attack rolls against a creature if at least one of the baboon's allies is within 5 ft. of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.

ACTIONS

Bite (melee). Attack: +1, melee 5ft Damage: 1d4-1 piercing

GIANT WOLF SPIDER - GIANT WOLF SPIDER

Medium beast, unaligned

exotic animal escaped from crates

Armor Class 13

Hit Points 11 (2d8+2)

Speed 40 ft.

Senses Blindsight 10 ft., Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages -

Challenge 1/4

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	16 (+3)	13 (+1)	3 (-4)	12 (+1)	4 (-3)

Spider Climb. The spider can climb difficult surfaces, including upside down on ceilings, without needing an ability check.

Web Sense. While in contact with a web, the spider knows the exact location of any other creature in contact with the same web.

Web Walker. The spider ignores movement restrictions caused by webbing.

ACTIONS

Bite (melee). Attack: +3, melee 5ft Damage: 1d6+1 piercing + 2d6 poison (CON DC 11, halved)

POISONOUS SNAKE - POISONOUS SNAKE

Tiny beast, unaligned

exotic animal escaped from crates

Armor Class 13

Hit Points 2 (1d4)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses Blindsight 10 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages -

Challenge 1/8

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
2 (-4)	16 (+3)	11 (+0)	1 (-5)	10 (+0)	3 (-4)

ACTIONS

Bite (melee). Attack: +5, melee 5ft Damage: 1 piercing + 2d4 poison (CON DC 10, halved)

RHINOCEROS - RHINOCEROS

Large beast, unaligned

exotic animal trapped in the warehouse

Armor Class 11 (natural armor)

Hit Points 45 (6d10+12)

Speed 40 ft.

Senses passive Perception 11

Languages -

Challenge 2

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
21 (+5)	8 (-1)	15 (+2)	2 (-4)	12 (+1)	6 (-2)

Charge. If the rhinoceros moves at least 20 ft. straight toward a target and then hits it with a gore attack on the same turn, the target takes an extra 2d8 bludgeoning damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 15 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

ACTIONS

Gore (melee). Attack: +7, melee 5ft Damage: 2d8+5 bludgeoning

BANDIT - BANDIT

Medium humanoid (human), chaotic neutral

Er Braccio's henchman

Armor Class 12 (leather armor)

Hit Points 11 (2d8+2)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses passive Perception 10

Languages Common

Challenge 1/8

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)

ACTIONS

Scimitar (melee). Attack: +3, melee 5ft Damage: 1d6+1 slashing

Light Crossbow (ranged). Attack: +3, ranged 80/320 ft. Damage: 1d8+1 piercing

CONTESSINA - THE COUNTESS

*Medium humanoid (human), lawful neutral
noblewoman, wife of the Count of Fianus*

Armor Class 15 (breastplate)

Hit Points 9 (2d8)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses passive Perception 12

Languages Common

Challenge 1/8

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)

Parry. The Countess adds 2 to her AC against one melee attack that would hit her. She must see the attacker and be wielding a melee weapon.

ACTIONS

Rapier (melee). Attack: +3, melee 5ft Damage: 1d8+1 piercing

DOMINA LELLA

Medium humanoid (humanoid), neutral



Armor Class 10

Hit Points 1

Speed 30 ft.

Challenge 1

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)

ACTIONS

****Rolling Pin.**** +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target.

Hit: 1d4+2 bludgeoning damage..

DM Notes. Doesn't fight seriously, but the rolling pin is a credible threat at the table. STR 14 and Intimidation reflect the fact that nobody in Fianus Romanus dares contradict her. Knows everything about everyone, but you have to pay her or treat her well to get her to talk.

ERBRACCIO - ER BRACCIO

*Medium humanoid (human), chaotic neutral
bandit leader, port crime boss*



Armor Class 15 (studded leather)

Hit Points 65 (10d8+20)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses passive Perception 10

Languages Common

Challenge 2

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)

Multiattack. Er Braccio makes three melee attacks: two with his scimitar and one with his dagger.

ACTIONS

Scimitar (melee). Attack: +5, melee 5ft Damage: 2d6+3 slashing

Dagger (melee/ranged). Attack: +5, melee 5ft or ranged 20/60 ft. Damage: 1d4+3 piercing

FLAVIA - FLAVIA "THE SNAKE"

Medium humanoid (human), neutral
former seller of invigorating potions

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 4 (1d8)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses passive Perception 11

Languages Common

Challenge 0

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)

ACTIONS

Small knife (melee). Attack: +2, melee 5ft Damage: 1d4 piercing

THE COUNT

Medium humanoid (human), neutral

Living MacGuffin, quest giver

Armor Class 15 (breastplate)

Hit Points 9 (2d8)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses passive Perception 12

Languages Common, Elvish

Challenge 1/8

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)

Parry. +2 to AC against one melee attack that would hit.
Must see the attacker and be wielding a melee weapon.

ACTIONS

Rapier (melee). Attack: +3, melee, reach 5ft / 1sq
Damage: 1d8+1 piercing

SERGIUS ARIMANO - ANTAGONIST

Medium humanoid (human), neutral evil

hidden antagonist



Armor Class 14 (leather armor)

Hit Points 18 (3d8+3)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses passive Perception 14

Languages Common, Elvish, Thieves' Cant

Challenge 1

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (-1)	16 (+3)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)

Expertise. Stealth, Investigation (double bonus already included)

Sneak Attack (2d6). once per turn, extra damage if he has advantage or an ally is adjacent to the target

Cunning Action. bonus action: Dash, Disengage, or Hide

Assassinate. advantage on attack rolls against creatures that haven't acted yet. Automatic critical hit against surprised creatures.

Ring of Shadows (magic item). can cast *Invisibility* (on self) 1/day. Doesn't require concentration but ends if he attacks or casts a spell.

ACTIONS

Dagger (melee/ranged). Attack: +5, melee 5ft / 1sq or ranged 20ft / 4sq - 60ft / 12sq Damage: 1d4+3 piercing (+2d6 Sneak Attack if applicable)

Hand Crossbow (ranged). Attack: +5, ranged 30ft / 6sq - 120ft / 24sq Damage: 1d6+3 piercing (+2d6 Sneak Attack if applicable)

SIRGORIMVEL - ALLY

Medium humanoid (human), lawful neutral
main ally, quest giver



Armor Class 16 (chain mail + shield)

Hit Points 28 (3d10+6)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses passive Perception 11

Languages Common, Dwarvish

Challenge 1

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)

Fighting Style: Defense. +1 AC when wearing armor (already included)

Second Wind (1/short rest). bonus action, recovers 1d10+3 HP

Action Surge (1/short rest). one additional action on his turn

Rallying Cry. when he uses Second Wind, up to 3 allies within 60ft / 12sq recover 3 HP each. Mechanically: Gorim shouts "MOVE IT, COME ON!" and everyone feels slightly better, more from fear than inspiration.

ACTIONS

Longsword (melee). Attack: +4, melee, reach 5ft / 1sq Damage: 1d8+2 slashing (1d10+2 two-handed without shield)

Dagger (melee/ranged). Attack: +4, melee 5ft / 1sq or ranged 20ft / 4sq - 60ft / 12sq Damage: 1d4+2 piercing

THUG - HENCHMAN

Medium humanoid (human), neutral evil

Sergius's henchman

Armor Class 11 (leather armor)

Hit Points 32 (5d8+10)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses passive Perception 10

Languages Common

Challenge 1/2

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)

Pack Tactics. advantage on attack rolls if an ally is within 5 ft. of the target

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Effect: The thug makes two melee attacks.

Mace (melee). Attack: +4, melee 5ft Damage: 1d6+2 bludgeoning

Heavy Crossbow (ranged). Attack: +2, ranged 100/400 ft. Damage: 1d10 piercing
